

'Not retiring from ODIs'

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Rohit Sharma saved his best for last, both on and off the field. The skipper led the Men in Blue to a record third ICC Champions Trophy title, top-scoring in the final.

Later, Rohit was at his animated best during the post-match press conference. After patiently answering questions from the press for over 20 minutes, he signed off with a remark that will delight fans worldwide.

"I am not going to retire from this format. I want to make sure that no rumours are spread," Rohit declared as he exited the stage.

Reflecting on the team's triumph, the 37-year-old expressed satisfaction that every player had contributed to the victory.

"In this tournament, we have seen that from the first match till now, all the boys have contributed. If you see from number 1 to 11, the boys who have had the chance to bat or bowl, they have contributed in their own way. Eventually, when everyone plays together and a lot of people contribute, you get a lot of success consistently."

Rohit set the tone for India's chase, delivering a blistering start with 49 off 40 balls in the PowerPlay. His 105-run opening stand with Shubman Gill laid a strong foundation, and he went on to score a fluent 76 off 83 balls. Discussing his own performance, Rohit said, "I did the same thing today (as in the previous games). I wanted to score in the PowerPlay as once the field

spreads out, it becomes difficult (to score). So you have to take chances at the top. I pick the bowlers and the spots to hit."

He further explained, "You may not see consistency in scores, but I know what I'm doing. I changed my game after 10 overs. You get a lot of happiness when you win a match, and when you make a contribution in it, it feels even better. In the 2019 World Cup I had a good run but we didn't win the title. It was not fun."

Varun Chakaravathy, who was not originally part of India's preliminary squad of 15, emerged as one of the standout performers of the tournament. He ended up as the second-highest wicket-taker, claiming nine wickets in three matches at an average of 15.11 and an economy rate of 4.53. After missing India's initial group-stage fixtures against Bangladesh and Pakistan, he made an immediate impact when brought into the XI, taking 5 for 42 against New Zealand.

"He has got something different about him," Rohit said. "When we are playing on such pitches, we want the batters to do something different